

The Law of Sin and Death Has Been Broken Over You

The other Wednesday night I turned the mics off and refused to record an exhortation I did over prayer because God had me go back into my life and show me where my shortcomings were. Then, as the world would say, I had to own up to them and admit that God had not failed me.

Anything that has happened to me has happened because of the fact that God did not fail me, and the cross has seen to it that sin has no more dominion over me.

When we talk about sin, we are talking about all the by-products or fruit of sin. Whether it is disease, demon possession, poverty, lack, or any of these things, they are directly or indirectly a result of the fall. One way or another, they are stepchildren of fallen man and a result of the law of sin and death.

So I have good news for anybody who can appropriate this revelation: your old man was crucified with Jesus on the cross, and sin does not have the power to dominate you anymore.

As He told me, I am telling you: your first step out of being dominated by sin or by any of the cohorts sin has to offer is this. It does not matter if, in your own estimation, the sin was more than you could bear. It does not matter if the temptation seemed more than you could bear. If somebody asked you, "Were you forced into sinning?" you might say, "Yes, I was, because the temptation overpowered me. It was more than I could stand up under."

I have good news for you. Your first step out of that kind of domination is to stand up and spit in the devil's face and tell him:

"I do not care if everybody in the world thinks that temptation was too great and I had to sin. I do not care if my own feelings and emotions say I had no choice. Devil, I want you, the world, and the flesh to know that Jesus has set me free from sin, and sin has no more dominion over me. I do not care if my own estimation and emotions say I had no choice. I want the devil to know I did have a choice, and neither he nor my flesh had the power to make me do what I will not do."

That, my friend, is your first step out of sin.

We have been studying Romans 7. As I have told you before, Romans 7 is an unregenerate man who has received the law.

The law was what God gave to Israel. He summed it up in the Ten Commandments: thou shalt not commit adultery, thou shalt not steal, thou shalt not bear false witness, thou shalt have no other gods before Me. God gave this law to an unregenerate man, and when He did, it set up the conflict we read about in Romans 7.

Romans 7 and 8 are the pivotal point for the entire Word of God. The Old Testament revolves around the New Testament, and the pivotal point is the change between Romans 7 and Romans 8.

Romans 7 is an unregenerate man who was spiritually dead with the motions of sin loose in his flesh. He received a commandment that was good, but he could not keep it. It set up the conflict we read about in Romans 7. In Romans 8, he gets set free.

Let us back up to the end of Romans 7:

For I delight in the law of God after the inward man:
But I see another law in my members,
warring against the law of my mind,
and bringing me into captivity to the law of sin which is in my members.
O wretched man that I am!
who shall deliver me from the body of this death?
I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord.

In other words, "I will tell you who will deliver me from this body of death: Jesus Christ my Lord."

Then Paul summarizes Romans 7:

So then with the mind I myself serve the law of God;
but with the flesh the law of sin.

He is saying, "With my mind I want to serve the law of God. When God gave me the commandments, I acknowledged that they were good, holy, and righteous, and I wanted to keep them. But I could not because I did not have a new-creation, born-again spirit fortifying my mind. Therefore the law of sin and death, the passions of sin in the flesh, declared war against my mind. My mind said I should not sin, but the law of sin brought it into captivity and said, 'I do not care if you do not want to. I am going to force you to do it.'"

That is what Paul exclaimed when he said, "O wretched man that I am."

The law was a schoolmaster to lead us to Christ. A schoolmaster teaches why things are necessary. The law revealed the nature of man and showed him that he needed a Redeemer.

Paul says, "Who shall deliver me from this body of death? Thank God, through Jesus Christ our Lord." Then he sums it up: "With my mind in this wretched state, I know the commandments are good, holy, and just. But another law is loose in my members. It declares war on my mind, forces me to sin, and I cannot seem to help it. God, what a wretched state I am in."

Then the pivotal point takes place. He graduates from Romans 7 to Romans 8 to show how, through Jesus Christ our Lord, we were made free to the degree that Romans 6 says, "Sin shall not have dominion over you."

Who is He setting free? This man controlled by the flesh.

I will tell you again: sin cannot make you do what you will not do. Your first step out of it is to stand up, even if your own estimation says you were forced into it and could not help it. Stand up and spit in the devil's face. Declare that you were set free on the cross when you were crucified with Jesus and the man of sin died with Him.

"Devil, you and this flesh, this devil-empowered flesh, cannot make me do what I will not do, because I am not under the law and I am not walking after the flesh anymore. I am walking after the Spirit because I have been set free."

Romans 8:1 says:

There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

Catch the wording. "There is therefore now," in the present state of the born-again man and woman, "no condemnation." The word condemnation means no condemning sentence, like a sentence brought forth in a court of law where you are pronounced guilty and condemned to death. The condemning sentence passed on you must now be carried out.

Paul is saying that because you have been born again, no condemning sentence executed upon you by the law and flesh can be carried out on you anymore. No condemning sentence by the flesh warring against your mind can make you sin anymore. It cannot.

There is therefore now no condemning sentence to those who are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh. In other words, they are no longer under the law. They have been born again and are walking after the Spirit.

Every time Paul uses language like "after the flesh," he is shifting back to Romans 7. He is describing the condition of an unregenerate man who received the law and could not keep it.

There is therefore now no condemning sentence by flesh, devil, or world that can be carried out in those who are in Christ Jesus, who are not under the law but have been born again.

What makes this true?

For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus
hath made me free from the law of sin and death.
For what the law could not do,
in that it was weak through the flesh,
God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh,
and for sin,
condemned sin in the flesh:
That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us,
who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

What the law could not do because it was weak through the flesh, Christ did. The commandments were good, just, and holy: do not commit adultery, do not covet, do not lie. There was one problem. They could not be fulfilled in an unregenerate man because he was weak through the flesh.

What the law could not accomplish in man, God accomplished by sending His own Son. Jesus stepped into your shoes and was made your sin. In the likeness of sinful flesh, by a sacrifice for sin, He condemned sin in your flesh.

Now the righteousness of the law can be fulfilled in you because the weakness of the flesh has been eliminated. Your old man has been crucified with Christ.

So again, I am going to tell you: sin shall have no more dominion over you.

"I cannot quit smoking."

That is because you do not want to. If you wanted to, you would quit. I am picking on a gnat now. I have already swallowed a camel. But anything you give yourself is nothing but an excuse. I know how powerful the flesh is, but either you are lying or He is lying, and I do not think it is Him.

The problem under the law was that the motions of sin wanted to sin. The mind could not stop it. Even though the mind had the knowledge of the law, it could not stop it. That is why millions of gallons of blood were shed to cover the salvation of men as a type of Jesus Christ.

But the very fact that they were sacrificed year after year brought remembrance of sins each year, because the blood of goats and bulls could not purge a man from the conscience of sin. A new nature can.

Under the law, the motions of sin declared war on the mind and said, "You are going to obey me." The man tried not to obey, but Paul said:

I see another law in my members,
warring against the law of my mind,
and bringing me into captivity to the law of sin.

Sure he could not win. When the law of sin declared war on his mind, he had a spiritually dead spirit. There was no resistance. There was nothing to stand against it with.

But now I have been born again. I have a new nature on the inside of me. This is what Paul is talking about when he says:

They that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh;
but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit.

Those after the flesh mind the things of the flesh because they do not have any choice. Their thought processes are captivated, dominated, and forced to bow to the flesh. But those after the Spirit have thought processes that can now bow to the new nature resident inside their spirit.

That is why Paul said:

If the Spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you,
he that raised up Christ from the dead shall also quicken your mortal bodies by his Spirit
that dwelleth in you.

The same Spirit who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you. He will quicken your mortal body and fortify you against sin.

So I am going to tell you again: sin shall have no more dominion over you, for you are not under the law but under grace.

Every time Paul mentions the flesh in Romans 7 and 8, he is describing the condition of an unregenerate man being dominated by the flesh, his mind captivated, with no born-again spirit to resist it.

Romans 8:3 says:

For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh,
God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh,
and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh.

He condemned sin in the flesh. He brought a condemning sentence against sin and put it to death.

"Brother Roberson, I am weak."

I understand that you do not have to sin if you do not want to.

Verse 4:

That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us,
who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

Verse 5:

For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh;
but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit.

Verse 6:

For to be carnally minded is death;
but to be spiritually minded is life and peace.

To be carnally minded, sense-ruled by the motions of sin in the flesh under the law, is death. But to be spiritually minded, to have a mind controlled by the law of the Spirit of life, is life and peace.

Verse 7:

Because the carnal mind is enmity against God:
for it is not subject to the law of God,
neither indeed can be.

Verse 8:

So then they that are in the flesh cannot please God.

What a statement.

Verse 9:

But ye are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit,
if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you.
Now if any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of his.

Wait a minute. What kind of blanket statement is this? If I pointed at some believers, it would be hard for me to say, "You are not in the flesh," because believers can fight and be carnal.

But that is not what he is talking about between verses 1 and 9. Romans 7 describes the condition of a man under the law. Romans 8 describes the condition of a man getting set free. Paul is making a comparison all the way down, shifting from Romans 7 to Romans 8.

What qualifies me not to be in the flesh? The Spirit of God dwells in me. I have the Spirit of Christ. Paul is saying I am no longer under the law with an unregenerate spirit and a mind captivated by the motions of sin in the flesh. I have been born again.

Again, I am going to tell you: you do not have to sin if you do not want to.

"These cigarettes have me bound."

No, they have you bound because you want to smoke. Make up your mind to get free, and He will get you free.

Are we turning into a holiness church? Not that kind. You can wear earrings; I do not care. But we are turning into a church that is going to receive revival. We are going to create a habitat for Him to come down freely in, if it kills all of us.

Amen.

Romans 8:10 says:

And if Christ be in you,
the body is dead because of sin;
but the Spirit is life because of righteousness.

If Christ is in you, the body is dead because of sin, but the Spirit is life because of righteousness.

Now jump ahead to verse 13:

For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die:
but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.
For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God.

Then verse 15:

For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry, Abba, Father.
The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit,
that we are the children of God.

We did not receive the spirit of bondage again to fear, the one under the law. We received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, "Abba, Father." His Spirit bears witness with our spirit that we are the children of God.

What happened when we got born again?

According to verse 10, if Christ is in you, the body is dead because of sin, but the Spirit has been declared life because of righteousness. Notice he did not say alive. People in hell are alive. He said the Spirit is life. It is Zoe, the God-kind of life, seated in heavenly places with Christ Jesus.

When Jesus came into my life, they said, "Will you accept Jesus Christ as your personal Savior?" I said, "Yes, I will." Immediately my spirit was born again and became a new creation. The old stony heart and the nature that went with it were taken out. I received a new nature and became a new creation.

My spirit is no longer born of the first Adam who fell from God. My spirit has been born of Christ, the last Adam. The old nature has been taken out and the new one put in. My spirit received a new nature and was seated in heavenly places with Christ Jesus. It is not just alive. People in hell are alive. It is life, the God-kind of Zoe life, in the image of Jesus Christ, seated with Him.

There is just one problem: as you have noticed, the trumpet has not sounded. I did not get a glorified body. I am not wearing a body given to me by the last Adam, Christ Jesus. I am still wearing a body given to me by the first man, Adam.

Consequently, unlike my spirit, which does not have death working in it anymore, my body still has death working in it from the first Adam. It will have it until the trumpet sounds. In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, the time it takes me to blink, my body will go from corruptible to incorruptible.

We shall all be changed. You will receive a glorified body. That glorified body will span both worlds. You can run around on earth or in heaven. There is nothing like it in the universe. Jesus has one right now.

When you receive your glorified body, Romans 8 calls that a manifested son of God. Right now, adoption papers have been served on you because you have been born again. Those of us who have the firstfruits of the Spirit groan in our righteous nature, that new born-again nature, waiting for the adoption process to be made complete at the redemption of our bodies.

I have a spirit made righteous, but I am still waiting on the redemption of my body, for it to be glorified. When the trumpet sounds, I will not be wearing a body given to me by the first Adam. I will be wearing a body given to me by the last Adam. The adoption process will be made complete, and I will be a manifested son of God: not only spirit, not only soul, but a glorified body.

Meanwhile, I am still getting wrinkles. My hair is getting gray and I am losing it. My forehead is extending itself all over my body. Pretty soon the dreaded comb-over will come into existence. Oh no, the comb-over!

I do not mind much. This thing is temporary. It was given to me to serve God with, to evangelize, to be an ambassador, and to carry the message as an ambassador of the kingdom of God. Faith will keep this body to a ripe old age to serve the kingdom with. I do not mind if I look like a prune at the end. Who cares? The trumpet will sound.

Manifested sonship will be made complete when you get a glorified body. Meanwhile, you have a body that has been crucified with Him. Positionally, it has been put to death, but it is still capable of sin.

This is why Paul says:

If Christ be in you, the body is dead because of sin;
but the Spirit is life because of righteousness.

Just as your spirit has received the positional truth of life, your body, which is capable of sin, has received the positional truth of death.

That is why verse 13 says:

If ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.

Through the law of the Spirit of life, you execute the mortification, the positional truth of death. That means He has taken the power of sin away from your flesh so it cannot dominate your mind anymore and cause you to serve it. Positionally, its power over you has been broken and it has been declared dead. It cannot dominate and rule over you anymore if you are full of the Holy Ghost and have been born again.

If you think sin can still dominate you, you have been deceived by the devil.

Let me tell you the danger of sin. If you want to adopt a philosophy of promiscuous grace or premeditated repentance so you can allow your flesh the convenience and opportunity to sin and then justify it under a doctrine, let me tell you what God told me.

God will walk through hell with a man who has faults that need restoring. How do you know it is a fault you want to be restored from? You hate the sin. You hate the faultiness of it as much as God does, and you want to be free. He will walk through hell with you.

There was a time when I was almost deceived by the devil into thinking I could not walk free of sin. I have seen friends fall into adultery and pornography. They would confide in me: "I seem to be hooked on pornography. Nobody in the whole world knows this, Brother Roberson. I trust you to pray for me. I hate it. I feel like a sleazeball every time I watch one of those movies or buy another book and hide it. I feel so condemned that I cry to God, 'Please help me.'"

One of the most horrible tricks of the devil is to keep you waiting for God to come and deliver you, when in reality, my friend, He already has. You need to stand up and agree with what God said.

It is the exception to the rule for Him to come and deliver you in that way. It does happen, often when enough saints pray hard enough over somebody who is lost and stand long enough, saying, "I will not be denied, God, so You might as well do it."

But the devil wants you to keep thinking your case is special, and unless God comes into your front room and does something for you, you cannot get free.

Listen to me. You have already been made free. You need to stand up with the Word that is in you and that mouth of yours. Appropriate that sin to the cross. Spit on the devil and say, "I do not care who you think you are. You cannot make me sin. Something in me is not yielding. God did not fail me. I want you to know that I am free. Even if I am still doing it, I am free."

They confided in me and said, "I cannot." I did not know as much then as I do now. I know you are free. I know you can. He said sin shall not have dominion over you.

Sin, cigarettes, and those things do not get me now. The battle I have now is in the flesh realm of complacency and indifference. It keeps saying, "You have tomorrow. You have tomorrow. Nobody else is declaring war in prayer and fasting. Why should I spend my life in the closet while other preachers spend it on the golf course?"

Complacency.

God told me the same rules apply.

I said, "What rules?"

"Sin shall not have dominion over you. If you want to pray, I have set you free. Quit using excuses. They do not hold water."

If I do not pray, it is because I do not want to. Some people use the feeble excuse of working. I am only kidding. Thank God Smith Wigglesworth did not use plumbing as a reason not to pray, or he would not have shaken his generation. He did not use it as an excuse, though it cost him many four o'clock mornings.

Most of us have been indoctrinated. I do not care what preacher gave it to you. We become victims of a system of thoughts. Complacency. Indifference.

Do not receive condemnation? Romans says there is therefore now no condemnation. What it is saying is that the law of sin and death has been broken over you, and the law cannot take your flesh and dominate your mind anymore. Those kinds of condemning sentences cannot be carried out in you anymore.

It is not talking about me attacking your complacency and you telling me, "Do not condemn me." That is not what Paul is talking about.

Most of us have been indoctrinated to the degree that we just coast along. Nothing jolts us out of it. Any group that ever caused revival was exceptional. They would not be denied. Nor did they afford themselves the luxury of excuses.

You may not be too happy right now having me as your pastor, but I can promise you this: if you stay on this train, when you and I enter heaven, you will enter with a reward.

My body has been declared dead. Positional truth. I have been crucified with Him. Positional truth. The body is quite alive, but the ability of the carnal nature of the flesh and sin to dominate me has been put to death. My old man has been crucified with Him, and positionally it has been declared dead.

Just to make sure it could not overpower me, He sent the Holy Spirit and said, "Sin shall not have dominion over you." If the same Spirit who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you, He will quicken your mortal body. Through the Spirit, you will mortify the deeds of the body.

If Christ is in me, my spirit is life because of righteousness. We are going to study the voice of God inside your spirit and how to listen to it, isolate it, and know it is Him, so you do not end up in Timbuktu thinking it is God. But I have to say the part He told me to say.

If Christ is in you, the Spirit is life. The body is declared dead. Fasting is an execution of that positional truth.

Fasting puts the flesh where it belongs. By execute, I mean fasting could not put the flesh anywhere by itself. You do it. Christ is in you; your body is dead. Fasting executes a positional truth that was given to you by Christ Jesus, just like praying in the Holy Ghost executes the spiritual truth of edification and executes your Christ rights of the cross.

The combination of fasting and prayer makes you a devil-stomping, mountain-moving, self-purging machine.

Again, Paul did not say the spirit was alive. He said it is life. People in hell are alive. Your spirit is going to live forever, my friend. Forever.

You are choosing right now not only where you will spend eternity, but how much reward you will have where you spend it. You are choosing this right now.

If you think His reward is nothing, my friend, the most singular, sought-after blessing in all of heaven is the reward of the Lamb. It is the cocaine of heaven, if you will allow me to say it that way. People would kill for it if they could. Some of you are throwing it away because you cannot get out of bed.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Did you have a good time this morning?

How many feel like letting go of the sin? How many believe it cannot dominate you?

I wish somebody had taught me how to crucify my indifference and complacency. I would not have lost so many battles to the old man.

Maybe it is okay. The law of the Spirit of life and I are going to win.

Let us stand up and worship God.

Glory be to God forever.